

OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in English Language (H470)

Specification

Version 1: First assessment 2017

This draft qualification has not yet been accredited by Ofqual. It is published to enable teachers to have early sight of our proposed approach to A Level English Language. Further changes may be required and no assurance can be given at this time that the proposed qualification will be made available in its current form, or that it will be accredited in time for first teaching in 2015 and first award in 2017.

Draft

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1 Why choose an OCR A Level in English Language?

1a. Why choose an OCR qualification?

Choose OCR and you have got the reassurance that you're working with one of the UK's leading exam boards. Our new A Level in English Language has been developed in consultation with teachers, employers and Higher Education to provide students with a qualification that is relevant to them and meets their needs.

We're part of the Cambridge Assessment Group, Europe's largest assessment agency and a department of the University of Cambridge. Cambridge Assessment plays a leading role in developing and delivering assessments throughout the world, operating in over 150 countries.

We work with a range of education providers, including schools, colleges, workplaces and other institutions in both the public and private sectors. Over 13,000 centres choose our A Levels, GCSEs and vocational qualifications including Cambridge Nationals, Cambridge Technicals and Cambridge Progression.

Our Specifications

We believe in developing specifications that help you bring the subject to life and inspire your students to achieve more.

We've created teacher-friendly specifications based on extensive research and engagement with the teaching community. They're designed to be straightforward and accessible so that you can tailor the delivery of the course to suit your needs. We aim to encourage learners to become responsible for their own learning, confident in discussing ideas, innovative and engaged.

We provide a range of support services designed to help you at every stage, from preparation through to the delivery of our specifications. This includes:

- A wide range of high-quality creative resources including:
 - Delivery Guides
 - Transition Guides
 - Topic Exploration Packs
 - Lesson Elements
 - ...and much more.
- Access to subject specialists to support you through the transition and throughout the lifetimes of the specifications.
- CPD/Training for teachers including face-to-face events to introduce the qualifications and prepare you for first teaching.
- Active Results – our free results analysis service to help you review the performance of individual students or whole schools.
- ExamCreator – our new online past papers service that enables you to build your own test papers from past OCR exam questions.

All A level qualifications offered by OCR are accredited by Ofqual, the Regulator for qualifications offered in England.

1b. Why choose an OCR A Level in English Language?

This A Level English Language specification is designed to give teachers and learners a well-structured, coherent and engaging course of study.

The three components of OCR's A Level in English Language complement and connect with each other in ways that support preparation for a linear A level qualification. The specification has been produced in consultation with experts from Higher Education and provides excellent preparation for further study in English Language or Linguistics as well as other academic disciplines and careers.

Through a rich and varied programme of study, learners will develop a deep knowledge of how English language works and a secure understanding of the language system. They will explore data and examples of language in use and apply concepts and methods appropriate for the analysis of language.

All learners will undertake an independent investigation in an area of particular and individual interest, and develop their skills as producers and interpreters of language. They are expected to engage creatively with topical issues relevant to language in use and develop their interest in and enjoyment of English.

Aims and learning outcomes

The aims of this specification are to encourage learners to develop their interest in and enjoyment of English as they:

- develop and apply their understanding of the concepts and methods appropriate for the analysis and study of language
- explore data and examples of language in use
- engage creatively and critically with a varied programme for the study of English
- develop their skills as producers and interpreters of language
- independently investigate language in use.

1c. What are the key features of this specification?

- The two examined components are distinctive and together support a coherent course of study.
- Component 01 focuses on knowledge and understanding of the language levels and application of critical analysis skills. It also includes an engaging writing production task where learners demonstrate their own language skills.
- Component 02 specifies interesting and varied contexts for further exploration of language in use: child language acquisition, language in the media and language change.
- The clear distinction between the two examined components retains a balance between learners learning to analyse the language levels effectively (Component 01) and learners exploring particular contexts or functions of language (Component 02).
- The independent investigation allows learners to pursue individual interests and is excellent preparation for Higher Education.
- The academic poster presentation in Component 03 is highly regarded by Higher Education and facilitates innovative teaching and learning.
- Using language creatively in Component 01 offers an opportunity for learners to demonstrate their engagement with contentious issues regarding language use. This allows teachers to incorporate current debates into their curriculum delivery, keeping the course fresh and modern.

1d. How do I find out more information?

If you are already using OCR specifications you can contact us at: www.ocr.org.uk

If you are not already a registered OCR centre, you can find out more information at www.ocr.org.uk

Want to find out more?

Ask a subject specialist:

Email: ocrenGLISH@ocr.org.uk

Customer Contact Centre: 01223 553998

Teacher support: www.ocr.org.uk

2 The specification overview

2a. Overview of A Level in English Language (H470)

Learners must complete all components (01, 02 and 03) to be awarded the A Level in English Language.

Content Overview	Assessment Overview	
• Linguistic analysis of authentic texts. • Original writing for a real-world purpose on a topical language issue. • Analysis of how children acquire language. • Language in the media. • How language changes over time. • An investigation into an area of each learner's particular individual interest.	Exploring language (01)* 80 marks 2 hours 30 minutes Written paper	40% of total A level
	Dimensions of linguistic variation (02)* 80 marks 2 hours 30 minutes Written paper	40% of total A level
	Independent language research (03)* 40 marks Non examined assessment	20% of total A level

* Indicates synoptic assessment.

Learners who are retaking the qualification may carry forward their result for the non exam assessment component.

2b. Content of A Level in English Language (H470)

The OCR A Level in English Language introduces learners to the concepts and methods of English language. Learners develop an ability to analyse a wide range of spoken and written forms of English, including electronic and multi-modal forms.

Learners will develop contextual and theoretical knowledge and understanding through their course of study.

Learners will develop a broad knowledge and understanding of the language levels, including:

- **Phonetics, phonology and prosodics:** how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed
- **Lexis and semantics:** the vocabulary of English, including social and historical variation
- **Grammar including morphology:** the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level
- **Pragmatics:** the contextual aspects of language use
- **Discourse:** extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts.

At A level, learners will apply the language levels to a range of contexts:

- historical
- geographical
- social and individual varieties of English
- aspects of language and identity.

This specification requires learners to apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data. Learners will apply critical and creative skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis, interpretation, and production of texts and discourses as well as accurately using a range of terminology associated with the study of language. Making accurate references to texts and sources is also a requirement.

The term data in the context of this specification refers to any source of English language that can be analysed. This may mean written texts, multimodal texts or transcriptions of speech. In the course of study this may also include speech or media sources which are experienced and explored without transcription.

In addition, A level learners will be expected to critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users and undertake independent investigations of language, selecting appropriate methods and techniques. Learners will also synthesise and reflect on language knowledge and understanding drawn from different areas of their studies.

Exploring language (Component 01) offers learners the opportunity to develop their ability to apply the analytical tools to texts in varying modes, as well as to engage with current debates around language use.

Dimensions of linguistic variation (Component 02) explores language use in particular contexts across time and place.

Independent language research (Component 03) allows learners to pursue an independent language investigation, developing the skills most valued by Higher Education and employers.

2c. Content of Exploring language (Component 01)

Exploring language (Component 01) focuses on linguistic analysis of authentic texts and original writing for a real-world purpose on a topical language issue.

There are three sections to this component:

- Section A: Language under the microscope
- Section B: Writing about a topical language issue
- Section C: Comparing and contrasting texts.

Exploring language		
Section	Topic coverage	Leaners should be able to:
A: Language under the microscope The focus of this section is on the effect of lexical choices and grammatical features in a short written text.	Learners should study a range of texts and genres. They are expected to be able to identify significant features or patterns in a text and to explore their effects. Learners should analyse language features in a range of contexts, exploring the possible effect of contextual factors on the way language is produced in the text and is received and understood by its audience.	• show, in relation to unseen texts, knowledge and understanding of: – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English, including social and historical variation – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts • show knowledge and understanding of how the language levels (above) can be applied to a range of contexts for language use, including: social and individual varieties of English; aspects of language and identity • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses (discourses in this context means extended stretches of communication) • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources.

Section	Topic coverage	Leaners should be able to:
B: Writing about a topical language issue This section focuses on an issue or concept related to language in use. Engaging with a variety of texts and contexts in Section A will help to prepare learners to emulate these styles in this section.	Learners should present and explore their ideas and attitudes towards language issues through short pieces of original writing. Learners should be encouraged to engage with a range of topical language issues in the course of their studies. They should develop the skills needed to critically explore such issues, evaluating and responding to the underlying attitudes towards language and language users. In writing about topical issues, learners should be given a real-world purpose, form and audience, and their writing should be shaped to match the genre, mode and context specified.	• show critical understanding of issues and concepts relevant to language use • critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users • demonstrate how texts and discourses are shaped in different genres, modes and contexts • apply critical and creative skills in the production of texts and discourses.
C: Comparing and contrasting texts The focus of this section is on exploring linguistic connections and comparisons between different modes of communication.	Learners should be prepared to compare a variety of texts, exploring the effects of mode and of language variations. For example, learners should be prepared to compare spoken and written texts; spontaneous and crafted speech; and different forms of spoken English, including individual and social varieties of English, and British regional dialects. Learners should focus on analysing linguistic features. However, they may choose to apply theoretical concepts and issues broadly, for example with reference to gender or power.	• show, in relation to unseen texts, knowledge and understanding of the language levels, including: – phonetics, phonology and prosodics: how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English, including social variation – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts

Section	Topic coverage	Leaners should be able to:
C: Comparing and contrasting texts		• show knowledge and understanding of how the language levels (above) can be applied to a range of contexts for language use, including: geographical, social and individual varieties of English; aspects of language and identity • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources • explore connections across different texts and discourses • show understanding of how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole.

2c. Content of Dimensions of linguistic variation (Component 02)

Dimensions of linguistic variation (Component 02) covers the topics of how children acquire language, language in the media, and how language changes over time.

There are three sections in this component:

- Section A: Child language acquisition
- Section B: Language in the media
- Section C: Language change.

Dimensions of linguistic variation		
Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
A: Child language acquisition The focus of this section is on children's acquisition of spoken language. The age range to be explored is from 0-7 years old.	Learners focus on linguistic analysis of a short sample of authentic children's spoken text. Some aspects of spoken text will be transcribed phonemically, using symbols from the International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA). A copy of the IPA is found in Section 5c and will be included in the exam paper. Learners should develop their analysis of linguistic features in the text with reference to theoretical concepts of child language acquisition to aid interpretation of the data.	• show knowledge and understanding of the language levels, including: – phonetics, phonology and prosodics: how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts • apply knowledge of the language levels (above) to a range of contexts for language use, including social and individual varieties of English and aspects of language and identity • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses

Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
A: Child language acquisition		• use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources.
B: Language in the media This section focuses on discourse in a multi-modal media text and requires learners to apply language concepts and theories to their analysis of linguistic and graphological features. This section is synoptic and will require learners to draw together their understanding of these different language concepts and issues, alongside the contextual aspects of a media text, in order to effectively analyse and evaluate language use in media texts.	Learners should consider relevant theories of language and power; language and gender or language and technology in exploring media texts. In preparing for this section, learners should explore: • language and power: the ways power is represented in a variety of texts and discourses • language and gender: the ways gender is represented and reproduced in a variety of texts and discourses • language and technology: the ways language varieties are shaped by the mode of communication and how different modal influences impact language use beyond that specific mode.	• show knowledge and understanding of the language levels, including: – phonetics, phonology and prosodics: how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English, including social variation – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts • apply knowledge of the language levels (above) to a range of contexts for language use, including social and individual varieties of English and aspects of language and identity • show understanding of how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources

Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
B: Language in the media		- consider the contextual aspects of language use and evaluate language in different genres, modes and contexts - synthesise and reflect on language knowledge and understanding drawn from different areas of their studies of English language.
Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
C: Language change The focus of this section is on the analysis of historical varieties of English. The analysis will be based on drawing connections and comparisons between two texts from different times.	Learners should study the ways that the English language has developed and changed over time, including methodologies for the study of language change. Learners should study a range of historical texts and genres. They are expected to be able to identify and compare significant features or patterns in texts from two different times and to explore their effects. Learners should be able to analyse language features in a range of contexts, comparing and contrasting the possible effects of contextual factors on the way language is produced in each text and is received and understood by their audiences.	- show knowledge and understanding of the language levels including: – phonetics, phonology and prosodics: how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English, including social and historical variation – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts - show knowledge and understanding of how the language levels (above) can be applied to a range of contexts for language use, including historical varieties of English - understand how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole - apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data - explore connections across different texts and discourses

Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
C: Language change		• apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources • critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users • synthesise and reflect on language knowledge and understanding drawn from different areas of their studies of English language.

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2d. Content of non exam assessment in A Level in English Language: Independent language research (Component 03)

Independent language research (Component 03) comprises two sections. Section A, An independent investigation of language, provides learners with the opportunity to pursue an area of study which is of particular personal interest. Section B, The academic poster, allows learners to present their research from their independent investigation in a concise and visually accessible way.

In Section B, only the poster will be assessed in this section. However, the 'real-world' purpose of the academic poster is for use in

conferences and to present research projects to a group of peers. This piece of work therefore provides an excellent opportunity for learners to present their research to each other, and could also be used to give the next year's cohort an insight into the types of investigation that have been undertaken, in order to stimulate their thinking. This provides excellent preparation for the types of activities undertaken in universities as a means to disseminate current research findings.

Independent language research		
Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
A: An independent investigation of language	Learners should: - introduce a field of interest - identify a research focus - select and apply an appropriate methodology for data collection - apply an appropriate method of linguistic analysis to the data collected - present and analyse their results - suggest possible conclusions - evaluate their investigation - include a bibliography. All learners will be expected to demonstrate the methodology used to conduct their investigation as part of their write-up, and to include some use of quantitative data analysis. The word count for this part of the independent language research is 2000–2500 words, excluding raw data and any appendices. There is no limit to the range of topics appropriate for an independent investigation, and individuality of approach is in the spirit of the specification.	- undertake an independent investigation of language, selecting and applying appropriate methods and techniques systematically - demonstrate knowledge of the language levels and how these can be applied in the chosen context - demonstrate understanding of how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole - apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriate and systematically to data. - apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses - use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language - make accurate references to texts and sources - critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users - demonstrate critical understanding of concepts and issues relevant to their chosen area of language study - analyse how contextual factors and language features shape meaning in their chosen area of study

Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
A: An independent investigation of language	Guidance and advice on the suitability of non exam assessment investigations is available from OCR.	• synthesise and reflect on language knowledge and understanding drawn from different areas of their study of English language.

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Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
B: The academic poster	The academic poster is a way to communicate about a complex topic (the learner's investigation) in a concise and visually accessible way. The aim of the learner's academic poster is to produce a well-researched and effectively organised overview of the learner's own independent investigation in a form that would be suitable for display at an undergraduate conference for English language research. The poster presentation is a recognised academic discipline and provides an opportunity for learners to demonstrate their ability to distil the detail of their investigation into its core features and findings. The poster should also include a reflection section, exploring limitations to the study, and potential next steps. The word count for this activity is 750–1000 words. The poster will assess the learner's ability to use English in a way that matches the requirements of the academic poster discipline. The focus of the task is to meet the purpose of this form of writing, rather than to present in an 'artistic' manner. Assessment therefore will consider control of style and accuracy but not the aesthetic nature of the final poster.	• show understanding of how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole • apply critical and creative skills in production of texts and discourses • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources • synthesise and reflect on knowledge and understanding drawn from their studies of English language • apply critical and creative skills in the production of their poster • demonstrate expertise in the use of English to communicate effectively.

2e. Prior learning and progression

The specification builds on the knowledge, understanding and skills established in GCSE English and in the National Curriculum Programmes of Study for Key Stage 4. It is expected that learners for A Level English Language will have studied English Language at GCSE level or equivalent.

Throughout the course of study learners are encouraged to develop a critical awareness of the structure of English and the ways in which the language is used, and to become confident and skilled in using English accurately and creatively.

This specification therefore provides a suitable foundation for the study of English Language, linguistics, or related courses in Higher Education. Equally it is also suitable for learners of various ages and backgrounds as part of a course of general education and lifelong learning.

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3 Assessment of OCR A Level in English Language

3a. Forms of assessment

The assessment of the OCR A Level in English Language is split into three linear components – two examined components

each worth 40% of the qualification and one non examined component worth 20%.

Exploring language (Component 01)

Exploring language is an externally-assessed written paper testing AO1, AO2, AO3, AO4 and AO5 through linguistic analysis of authentic texts and original writing for a real-world purpose on a topical language issue.

This component is worth 80 marks and represents 40% of the marks for A level. There are three sections to this component.

Section A: Language under the microscope

The focus of this section is on the effect of lexical choices and grammatical features in a short sample of written text. There is one question with two parts. The first part of the question requires learners to identify and analyse a lexical feature of the text, and the second part of the question requires learners to identify and analyse the use of a particular

grammatical feature. Both parts of the question require consideration of the influence of contextual factors. Learners are expected to identify significant features or patterns in the text and to explore their effects. There are 20 marks available for this task.

Section B: Writing about a topical language issue

This section focuses on an issue or concept related to language in use and gives learners the opportunity to present and explore their ideas and attitudes towards language

issues in a short piece of original writing. A real-world purpose, form and audience for the writing will be given in the task. There are 24 marks available for this task.

Section C: Comparing and contrasting texts

The focus of this section is on exploring linguistic connections and comparisons between different modes of texts, for example, in spoken and written texts, spontaneous and crafted speech or different forms of spoken English, which could include

British regional dialects. At least one spoken text will always be included in the paper. The focus is on analysis of linguistic features. However, learners may choose to apply theoretical concepts and issues broadly, for example, with reference to gender or power. There are 36 marks available for this task.

Dimensions of linguistic variation (Component 02)

Dimensions of linguistic variation is an externally-assessed paper testing AO1, AO2, AO3 and AO4 through analysis of how children acquire language, language in the

media, and how language changes over time. This component is worth 80 marks and represents 40% of the marks for A level. There are three sections in this component.

Section A: Child language acquisition

The focus of this section is on children's acquisition of spoken language. The age range to be explored is from 0–7 years old. The focus is on linguistic analysis of a short sample of authentic children's spoken text. Transcribed spoken text will include phonemic features and a copy of the List of Phonemic Symbols and Signs will be

provided in the exam paper (see Appendix 5c).

Learners should develop their analysis of linguistic features in the text with reference to theoretical concepts of child language acquisition to aid interpretation of the data. There are 20 marks available for this task.

Section B: Language in the media

This section focuses on discourse in a multi-modal media text and requires learners to apply language concepts and theories to their analysis of linguistic and graphological features. For example, they may consider

relevant theories of language and power; language and gender or language and technology. There are 24 marks available for this task.

Section C: Language change

The focus of this section is on the analysis of historical varieties of English. The analysis will be based on drawing connections and comparisons between two texts from different

times. Texts chosen for the assessment will be from the 1600's to present day. There are 36 marks available for this task.

Independent language research (Component 03)

Independent language research is an internally assessed, externally moderated component testing AO1, AO2, AO3 and AO5 through independent research into an area of language study which is of particular

individual interest. This component is worth 40 marks and represents 20% of the marks for A level. There are two sections to this component.

Section A: An independent investigation of language

Learners should produce a write-up of their independent investigation of language. The word count for this part of the independent language research component is 2000–2500 words, excluding raw data and appendices. There are 30 marks available for this section.

The write-up should follow this structure:

- introduction and research focus
- methodology

- results
- analysis – including some use of quantitative data analysis
- conclusions
- evaluation
- bibliography
- appendices.

Section B: The academic poster

Learners should produce an academic poster that offers a well-researched and effectively organised overview of the learner's own independent investigation in a form which would be suitable for display at an undergraduate conference for English language research. Learners are expected to demonstrate their ability to distil the detail of their investigation into its core features and findings. The poster should also include a reflection section, exploring limitations to the study, and potential next steps. The word count for this activity is 750–1000 words.

The poster will assess the learner's ability to use English in a way that matches the requirements of the academic poster discipline. The focus of the task is to meet the purpose of this form of writing, rather than to present in an artistic manner. Assessment therefore will consider control of style and accuracy, but not the aesthetic nature of the final poster. There are 10 marks available for this section.

3b. Assessment availability

There will be one examination series available each year in June to **all** learners.

This specification will be certificated from the June 2017 examination series onwards.

3c. Assessment objectives (AO)

There are five assessment objectives in OCR's A Level in English Language. Learners are expected to demonstrate their ability to:

	Assessment Objective
AO1	Apply appropriate methods of language analysis, using associated terminology and coherent written expression.
AO2	Demonstrate critical understanding of concepts and issues relevant to language use.
AO3	Analyse and evaluate how contextual factors and language features are associated with the construction of meaning.
AO4	Explore connections across texts, informed by linguistic concepts and methods.
AO5	Demonstrate expertise and creativity in the use of English to communicate in different ways. <i>Note: This assessment objective must be targeted with at least one of AO2, AO3 or AO4, either in the same task or in two or more linked tasks.</i>

AO weightings in A Level in English Language:

The relationship between the assessment objectives and the components are shown in the following table:

Component	% of A level					
	AO1	AO2	AO3	AO4	AO5	Total
Exploring language (H470/01)	11%	6%	11%	6%	6%	40%
Dimensions of linguistic variation (H470/02)	11%	11%	12%	6%	0%	40%
Independent language research (H470/03)	5%	5%	5%	0%	5%	20%
	27%	22%	28%	12%	11%	100%

3d. Assessment of extended responses

The assessment materials for this qualification provide learners with the opportunity to demonstrate their ability to

construct and develop a sustained line of reasoning and marks for extended responses are integrated into the marking criteria for each component.

3e. Non exam assessment

Internal assessment criteria for Independent language research.

Section A: An independent investigation of language

All learners will be expected to demonstrate the methodology used to conduct their investigation, and to include some use of quantitative data analysis. The word count for

this part of the independent language research is 2000–2500 words, excluding raw data and any appendices. There are 30 marks available for this section.

Section B: The academic poster

The poster presentation is a recognised academic discipline and provides an opportunity for learners to demonstrate their ability to distil the detail of their investigation into its core features and findings.

The poster should also include a reflection section, exploring limitations to the study, and potential next steps. The word count for this activity is 750–1000 words. There are 10 marks available for this section.

Non exam assessment guidance

There are three different stages in the production of the non exam assessment: planning of the task; first draft; final submission.

1. Planning of the task

It is expected that the teacher will provide detailed guidance to learners in relation to the purpose and requirement of the task.

Teacher's advice might include:

- discussion and guidance on an appropriate and effective title
- recommended reading
- possible structure

- resolving practical and conceptual problems
- research techniques
- help with time planning
- monitoring of progress throughout the process to ensure that learners are proceeding successfully.

Guidance and advice on the suitability of investigations will be available from OCR.

2. First draft

What teachers can do: review the work in either written or oral form, concentrating on the appropriateness of the title, content, structure and references.

What teachers cannot do: having reviewed the learner's work it is not acceptable for teachers to give, either to individual learners or to groups, detailed advice and suggestions as to how the work may be improved in order to meet the assessment criteria.

Examples of unacceptable assistance include:

- detailed indication of errors or omissions
- advice on specific improvements needed to meet the criteria
- the provision of outlines, paragraph or section headings or writing frames specific to the non exam assessment task(s)
- personal intervention to improve the presentation or content of the work.

3. Final submission

Once the final draft is submitted it must not be revised:

- in no circumstances are 'fair copies' of marked work allowed
- adding or removing any material to or from the work after it has been presented by a learner for final assessment would constitute malpractice.

Further information can be found on the [OCR website](#) and in Section 4, Admin: what you need to know.

3e. Non exam assessment marking criteria for Section A: An independent investigation of language

There are a total of 30 marks available for this section. Decide on a mark for AO1 out of 10, then a separate mark for AO2 out of 10, and a separate mark for AO3 out of 10. Add the three marks together to reach a total out of 30 marks. It is possible that candidates may achieve different levels for each AO: allocate the mark according to the level of competency demonstrated for each AO individually.

Level	Marks	AO1	Marks	AO2	Marks	AO3
Level 5	AO1 9–10	- Candidates apply a wide range of appropriate methods in an incisive and systematic way, using appropriate terminology. - The investigation is written in a secure academic register.	AO2 9–10	- Candidates show an assured knowledge and understanding of concepts and issues relevant to the focus of the language investigation. - Candidates engage critically with the application of the concepts and issues relevant to their investigation.	AO3 9–10	- Candidates offer a discerning exploration of a range of contexts and their association with how meanings are constructed in their data. - Candidates evaluate in perceptive detail how contextual features inherent in the text are associated with the construction of meaning, suggesting alternative interpretations.
Level 4	AO1 7–8	- Candidates apply a range of appropriate methods to the texts in a systematic way, using appropriate terminology. - The investigation is written in a clear and coherent manner.	AO2 7–8	- Candidates show a good knowledge and understanding of the concepts and issues relevant to the language investigation. - Candidates show that they can take a critical angle on the concepts and issues relevant to their investigation.	AO3 7–8	- Candidates respond in detail to a range of contexts and their potential influences on the construction of meaning from their data. - Candidates analyse in detail how contextual features inherent in the text are associated with the construction of meaning.

Level 3	AO1 5–6	- Candidates apply some appropriate methods in a sound way, using mostly appropriate terminology. - Writing is coherent if uneconomical.	AO2 5–6	- Candidates show an essentially sound level of knowledge and understanding of concepts and issues relevant to the language investigation. - Candidates show that they have some ability to think and write critically about relevant concepts/issues.	AO3 5–6	- Candidates make a sound attempt to respond to a range of contexts and their potential influences on construction of meaning from their data. - Candidates make clear, relevant response to the contextual features inherent in their data and how these are associated with the construction of meaning.
Level 2	AO1 3–4	- Candidates attempt to apply linguistic methods with some success, and terminology is at times appropriate. - Writing contains some errors or is assertive rather than analytical.	AO2 3–4	- Candidates knowledge and understanding of relevant language concepts or issues is mostly accurate, although is likely to lack the depth needed to be convincing. - Candidates have addressed the relevant language concepts/issues, although not critically.	AO3 3–4	- Candidates make some attempts to respond to contexts and make some points about their potential influences on the construction of meaning from their data. - Candidates make general or overly assertive or simplistic comments regarding the contextual features inherent in their data, showing some understanding of how these are associated with the construction of meaning.
Level 1	AO1 1–2	- Learners make a vague attempt to apply linguistic methods to their data and some terms are used, with occasional appropriate-ness. - Writing is likely to contain errors which sometimes obscure meaning, or lacks analysis with evidence.	AO2 1–2	- Candidate's knowledge and understanding of relevant concepts/issues is likely to have inaccuracies or be muddled. - The language concepts/issues are presented in the investigation, although their treatment is somewhat indistinct or confused.	AO3 1–2	- Candidates make a limited response to contexts and to their potential influences on the construction of meaning from their data. - Candidates show a basic understanding of how contextual features inherent in their data contribute to overall meanings.

0 marks: No response or no response worthy of credit.

3e. Non exam assessment marking criteria for Section B: The academic poster

Level	AO5
Level 5 9–10 marks	• A fluently constructed text, showing a sophisticated transformation of register and style from that used in the investigation into the academic poster form. • The creative use of appropriately chosen linguistic features shows flair and the writing precisely suits the intended audience.
Level 4 7–8 marks	• A well-constructed text, which demonstrates an appropriate transformation of register and style from that used in the investigation into the academic poster form. • The creative use of appropriately chosen linguistic features shows skill and their writing suits the intended audience.
Level 3 5–6 marks	• A deliberately constructed text, which contains most of the main elements of the academic poster form. • There is clear use of appropriate linguistic features and the writing has been modulated to take account of the intended audience.
Level 2 3–4 marks	• A text which is attempting to match the task's purpose and which is at least recognisable as an example of the academic poster form. • There are some appropriate language features employed and some attempts have been made to take account of the intended audience.
Level 1 1–2 marks	• A text which has some sense of the academic poster form, but which leaves out key elements. • There are some attempts to use appropriate language features, although probably not employing a register which suits the intended audience.

0 marks: No response or no response worthy of any credit.

3f. Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment allows learners to demonstrate their understanding between different aspects of the subject.

Synoptic assessment involves the explicit drawing together of knowledge, skills and understanding of different aspects of the A level course. The emphasis of synoptic assessment is to encourage the understanding of English language as a discipline.

Synoptic assessment is embedded throughout the A level.

Synoptic assessment tests the learners understanding of the connections between different elements of the subject. Each A level component fulfils this requirement,

although this is particularly evident in the non exam assessment component. All elements of the A level require a synthesis of insights developed through the application of linguistic knowledge to the study of speech, writing and multi-modal texts in a variety of contexts, bringing a range of concepts and issues to bear when exploring texts.

Independent language research (Component 03) gives learners an opportunity to work independently, pursuing a particular interest and developing expertise that builds on study from elsewhere in the course. Component 03 allows learners to apply synoptically their knowledge and skills, demonstrating the coherent learning that has taken place across the course as a whole.

3g. Calculating qualification results

A learner's overall qualification grade for A Level in English Language will be calculated by adding together their marks from the three components taken to give their total weighted mark. This mark will then be compared to the

qualification level grade boundaries for the entry option taken by the learner and for the relevant exam series to determine the learner's overall qualification grade.

4 Admin: what you need to know

The information in this section is designed to give an overview of the processes involved in administering this qualification so that you can speak to your exams officer. All of the following processes require you to submit something to OCR by a specific deadline.

More information about these processes, together with the deadlines, can be found in the *OCR Admin Guide and Entry Codes: 14–19 Qualifications*, which can be downloaded from the OCR website: www.ocr.org.uk

4a. Pre-assessment

Estimated entries

Estimated entries are your best projection of the number of learners who will be entered for a qualification in a particular series.

Estimated entries should be submitted to OCR by the specified deadline. They are free and do not commit your centre in any way.

Final entries

Final entries provide OCR with detailed data for each learner, showing each assessment to be taken. It is essential that you use the correct entry code, considering the relevant entry rules.

Final entries must be submitted to OCR by the published deadlines or late entry fees will apply.

All learners taking A Level in English Language must be entered for one of the following entry options below.

Entry code	Title	Component code	Component title	Assessment type
H470	English Language	01	Exploring language	External Assessment
		02	Dimensions of linguistic variation	External Assessment
		03	Independent language research	Non Exam Assessment (Postal moderation)
H470C	English Language (Non exam assessment Carried Forward)	01	Exploring language	External Assessment
		02	Dimensions of linguistic variation	External Assessment
		80	Independent language research (Carried forward)	Non Exam Assessment (Carried Forward)

* Entry option H470C should only be selected for learners who are retaking the qualification who want to carry forward their mark for the non exam assessment.

Estimated grades

An estimated grade is the grade the centre expects a learner to achieve for a

qualification. These should be submitted to OCR by the specified deadline.

4b. Accessibility and special consideration

The A level qualification and subject criteria for English Language have been reviewed in order to identify any feature which could disadvantage candidates who share a protected Characteristic as defined by the Equality Act 2010. All reasonable steps have been taken to minimise any such disadvantage.

Reasonable adjustments and access arrangements allow learners with special educational needs, disabilities or temporary injuries to access the assessment and show what they know and can do, without changing the demands of the assessment. Applications

for these should be made before the examination series. Detailed information about eligibility for access arrangements can be found in the *JCQ Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments*.

Special consideration is a post-assessment adjustment to marks or grades to reflect temporary injury, illness or other indisposition at the time the assessment was taken. Detailed information about eligibility for special consideration can be found in the *JCQ A guide to the special consideration process*.

4c. External assessment arrangements

Regulations governing examination arrangements are contained in the *JCQ Instructions for conducting examinations*.

4d. Non exam assessment

Regulations governing arrangements for internal assessments are contained in the *JCQ Instructions for conducting coursework*.

Authentication of learner's work

Learners and centres must declare that the work is the learner's own.

Teachers must declare that the work submitted for internal assessment is the

learner's own work by submitting a centre authentication form (CCS160) for each internally assessed component. This should be sent to the moderator at the same time as the marks.

Internal standardisation

Centres must carry out internal standardisation to ensure that marks awarded by different teachers are accurate

and consistent across all learners entered for the component from that centre.

Moderation

The purpose of moderation is to bring the marking of internally-assessed components in all participating centres to an agreed standard. This is achieved by checking a sample of each centre's marking of learners' work.

Following internal standardisation, centres submit marks to OCR and the moderator. If there are fewer than 10 learners, all the work should be submitted for moderation at the same time as marks are submitted.

Once marks have been submitted to OCR and your moderator, centres will receive a moderation sample request. Samples will

include work from across the range of attainment of the learners' work.

The moderation for A Level in English Language will be postal moderation.

Centres will receive the outcome of moderation when the provisional results are issued. This will include:

Moderation Adjustments Report – Listing any scaling that has been applied to internally-assessed components.

Moderator Report to Centres – A brief report by the moderator on the internal assessment of learners' work.

Carrying forward

Learners who are retaking the qualification can choose either to retake the non exam assessment or to carry forward their mark for that component from the previous exam series. If a learner decides to carry forward their mark, they must be entered in the retake series using the entry code for the carry forward option H470C.

- Learners must decide at the point of entry whether they are going to carry forward the non exam assessment, or if they are going to retake it to count towards their result. It is not possible for a learner to retake the non exam

assessment and then choose whether the retake result or a carried forward result is used for certification.

- Learners can only carry forward from one year into the following year. Where the gap between the initial qualification and the retake is more than one year, carry forward is not permitted.
- A result for a non exam assessment component can only be carried forward once.

4e. Results and certificates

Grade scale

A level qualifications are graded on the scale: A*, A, B, C, D, E, where A* is the highest. Learners who fail to reach the minimum

standard for E will be Unclassified (U). Only subjects in which grades A* to E are attained will be recorded on certificates.

Results

Results are released to centres and learners for information and to allow any queries to be resolved before certificates are issued.

Centres will have access to the following results information for each learner:

- the grade for the qualification
- the raw mark for each component
- the total weighted mark for the qualification.

The following supporting information will be available:

- raw mark grade boundaries for each component
- weighted mark grade boundaries for each entry option.

Until certificates are issued, results are deemed to be provisional and may be subject to amendment. A learner's final results will be recorded on an OCR certificate.

The qualification title will be shown on the certificate as 'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in English Language'.

4f. Post-results services

A number of post-results services are available:

- **Enquiries about results** – If you are not happy with the outcome of a learner's results, centres may submit an enquiry about results.
- **Missing and incomplete results** – This service should be used if an individual subject result for a learner is missing, or the learner has been omitted entirely from the results supplied.
- **Access to scripts** – Centres can request access to marked scripts.

4g. Malpractice

Any breach of the regulations for the conduct of examinations and non examined assessments may constitute malpractice (which includes maladministration) and must be reported to OCR as soon as it is detected.

Detailed information on malpractice can be found in the JCQ publication *Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments: Policies and Procedures*.

5 Appendices

5a. Grade descriptors

Details to be confirmed by Ofqual.

5b. Overlap with other qualifications

There is some overlap between the content of this specification and that of OCR's A Level in English Language and Literature (EMC). Learners who enter for this A Level in English Language specification may not also

enter for any other A level specification with the certification title *English Language and Literature* in the same examination series. They may, however, enter for A Level in English Literature.

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5c. List of phonemic symbols and signs (RP)

1. CONSONANTS OF ENGLISH

/f/	—	fat, rough
/v/	—	very, village, love
/θ/	—	theatre, thank, athlete
/ð/	—	this, them, with, either
/s/	—	sing, thinks, losses
/z/	—	zoo, beds, easy
/ʃ/	—	sugar, bush
/ʒ/	—	pleasure, beige
/h/	—	high, hit, behind
/p/	—	pit, top, spit
/t/	—	tip, pot, steep
/k/	—	keep, tick, scare
/b/	—	bad, rub
/d/	—	bad, dim
/g/	—	gun, big
/tʃ/	—	church, lunch
/dʒ/	—	judge, gin, jury
/m/	—	mad, jam, small
/n/	—	man, no, snow
/ŋ/	—	singer, long
/l/	—	loud, kill, play
/j/	—	you, pure
/w/	—	one, when, sweet
/r/	—	rim, bread

2. PURE VOWELS OF ENGLISH

/i:/	—	beat, keep
/i/	—	bit, tip, busy
/e/	—	bet, many
/æ/	—	bat
/ʌ/	—	cup, son, blood
/ɑ:/	—	car, heart, calm, aunt
/ɒ/	—	pot, want
/ɔ:/	—	port, saw, talk
/ə/	—	about
/ɜ:/	—	word, bird
/ʊ/	—	book, wood, put
/u:/	—	food, soup, rude

3. DIPHTHONGS OF ENGLISH

/ei/	—	late, day, great
/ai/	—	time, high, die
/ɔɪ/	—	boy, noise
/aʊ/	—	cow, house, town
/əʊ/	—	boat, home, know
/iə/	—	ear, here
/eə/	—	air, care, chair
/ʊə/	—	jury, cure